



LinkChat

Your LinkedIn conversations, and the sequences that run off them, on your own computer — reading and writing through the CRM you already built.

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github.com/ashleydeansmith/linkchat

Windows and Mac · open source · nothing is sent without you pressing something

What it is, and what it keeps

LinkChat is four screens over the CRM you built in Sessions 0 to 2. It reads your LinkedIn inbox onto this computer, shows you what is waiting, and carries a message into a conversation once you have approved it.

The part worth understanding first is what it does **not** hold. LinkChat keeps no record about a person. Your people, your event log, your daily limit and your do-not-message list all stay in your CRM, and LinkChat reads them from there through one file. Point it at a different CRM and everything it knows changes, because it knew none of it.

That is why there is nothing to export if you stop using it, and why two copies of LinkChat pointed at one CRM cannot disagree about who you have messaged today.

The four screens

Home	Conversations	Sequences	Campaigns	Live
What is waiting, and one next step worked out for you.	Your LinkedIn inbox, read onto this computer.	What you say when somebody replies, and to which kind of reply.	Connection requests, withdrawals, and reading a saved search.	What your CRM has recorded, newest first.

NOTHING HAPPENS ON ITS OWN

LinkChat runs when you press something. There is no clock in it and no job waiting to fire while you are away. A message goes when you press Send or approve one, and a copy is written into your outbox before it is carried, so a send that fails still leaves you the words.

What you need before you start

Four things. Two you already have if you finished Session 2. The whole list is here so nothing arrives as a surprise halfway through.

01 **The CRM you built in Sessions 0 to 2**

The folder with `_engine` and `People` inside it. LinkChat reads your daily limit, your do-not-message list and your records from there. No cost.

02 **Python 3.10 or later**

From python.org. Free. Tick the box marked **Add python.exe to PATH** on the installer's first screen; without it the LinkChat installer cannot find Python afterwards.

03 **Git**

From git-scm.com. Free. Used once to copy the program down, and again each time you want the newest version.

04 **About 400 MB of disk, and five minutes**

Most of it is the browser LinkChat reads LinkedIn with, downloaded during the install. No account and no payment at any point.

ON A MAC

Everything works the same, with one difference: you run `setup-mac.command` rather than `setup.cmd`, and where this document says `python` you type `python3`. The Mac installer builds LinkChat its own private Python inside the LinkChat folder, because the Python a Mac ships with refuses to have anything installed into it.

Getting it onto your computer

1 Open a terminal. On Windows press the Start button, type `cmd`, and press Enter. On a Mac press Command and Space, type `Terminal`, and press Enter. Every line below is typed there, one at a time, pressing Enter after each.

2 Copy the program down.

```
cd %USERPROFILE%\Documents
git clone https://github.com/ashleydeansmith/linkchat.git LinkChat
```

On a Mac the first line is `cd ~/Documents` instead. You now have a folder called `LinkChat` inside Documents.

If that second line comes back saying the repository could not be found, the copy you were pointed at is not open to you. Say so — it is one setting at the other end, not something wrong with your computer.

3 Run the installer. Open `Documents\LinkChat` in File Explorer and double-click `setup.cmd`. On a Mac, double-click `setup-mac.command`.

It prints four lines as it goes and takes about five minutes, most of it downloading the browser. It ends with a LinkChat icon on your desktop.

4 Double-click the icon. LinkChat opens in its own window and asks where your CRM is.

IF ANY OF THAT DOES NOT GO AS WRITTEN

In the terminal, move into the folder and ask the program what it can see:

```
cd %USERPROFILE%\Documents\LinkChat
python doctor.py
```

It reports which computer this is, which installer belongs to it, which Python you have and whether it is one of the two impostors, which parts are installed, whether the browser downloaded, and whether it has been pointed at a CRM — then one line saying what to do next. It looks only: it installs nothing, changes nothing and sends nothing. On a Mac the line is `python3 doctor.py`.

Pointing it at your CRM

Asked once, the first time you open it. Two boxes.

Point LinkChat at your CRM

LinkChat keeps no record about a person. Your people, your event log, your daily limit and your hold list all stay in the CRM you built, and LinkChat reads them from there.

The folder your CRM is in

It is the folder with `_engine` and `People` inside it — the one Layer 1 made.

Your name

This goes on the approval line. A sequence writes a message and cannot approve its own work, so every message that reaches your outbox carries the name of the person who said it could: you.

CancelUse this CRM

Both boxes are explained on the panel itself. Your name is the one people miss: it goes on the approval line of every message that reaches your outbox.

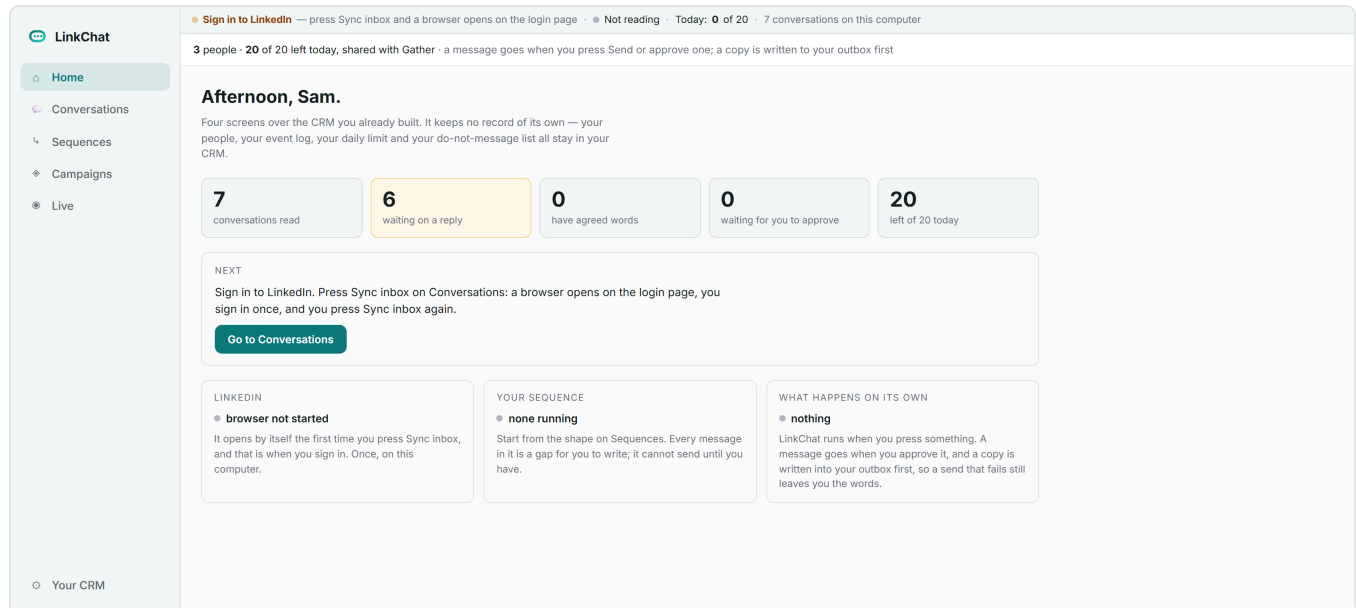
If your CRM has not reached Layer 6, LinkChat opens anyway and reads everything. It will not send until Layer 6 is installed, and it says so on the screen rather than refusing to open. Nothing is broken; it turns on by itself when the layer is there.

What it goes looking for

Eight parts of your CRM, by name: the part that checks a message before it goes, your do-not-message list, your daily limit, your event log, your review step, the part that works out that one person is one person, the part that knows where your folders are, and the lock that stops two jobs driving the browser at once. Any that are missing are named on the screen, and what LinkChat can do shrinks to match — rather than failing at the moment you press something.

Home

What is waiting, and one next step — not a list of options, one step, worked out from what is actually true right now.

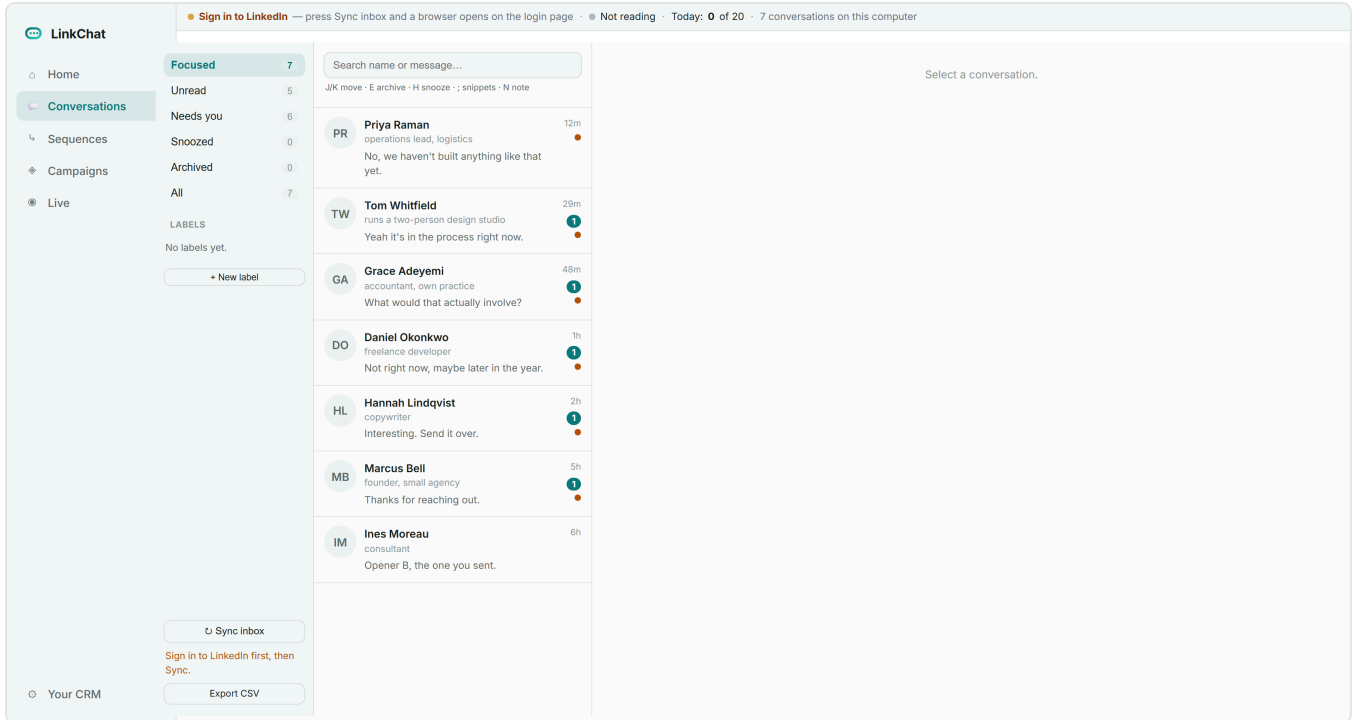


The strip along the top is on every screen: whether you are signed in to LinkedIn, whether it is reading, how much of today's limit is left, and how many conversations are on this computer. The three cards at the bottom answer the question people ask first — **what happens on its own**, and the answer is nothing.

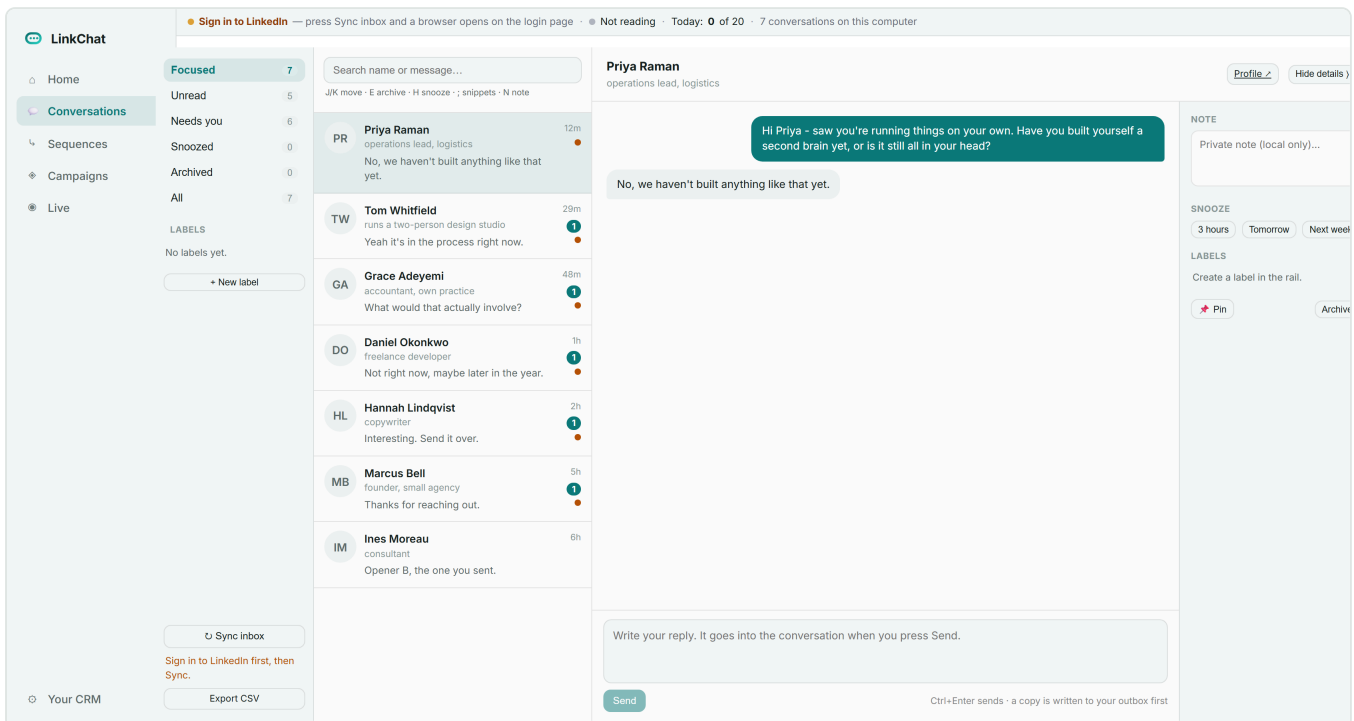
The five counts are read live. **Waiting on a reply** is the one that matters most days: conversations where they said something last and you have not answered. **Have agreed words** counts the ones your sequence recognises and has a message ready for. **Waiting for you to approve** is the review step — a sequence has written something and cannot release it itself.

Conversations

Your LinkedIn inbox, read onto this computer. Pressing **Sync inbox** is also what opens the browser the first time, and that is where you sign in — once, on this computer.



The boxes down the left are ways of narrowing the same list. **Needs you** is the working one: they replied and you have not answered. The names shown here are invented for this document.



A conversation open. The thread on the left, a private note and a snooze on the right, and the reply box at the bottom. What you type there goes into the conversation when you press **Send** — and a copy is written into your outbox first.

The five checks

Every message takes one road out, whoever wrote it. Five things have to be true before a single character reaches anybody.

01 **The parts that do the checking are installed**

If the part of your CRM that checks a message is not there, nothing is sent. A check that cannot be consulted is not an absent check.

02 **They are not on your do-not-message list**

Asked in every way the address might be written down, not the one way it happens to be stored. Ten spellings of the same person all come back held.

03 **Nothing is left unfilled in the words**

A message still carrying `{name}` is the single most obvious way a message announces that nobody wrote it. It is refused, and the gap is named.

04 **Their own name field is not typed back at them**

Symbols in a name field are often put there to catch a machine. An emoji you deliberately wrote into your own words is your writing and is left alone.

05 **It is not a copy of a message you just approved**

Twenty different replies to twenty people is somebody having conversations. Twenty copies of one sentence is what gets an account limited.

There is a sixth for a message a **sequence** wrote: it goes to the review step in your CRM, and a sequence cannot release its own work. That is why the setup panel asked for your name.

LinkChat

Home

Conversations

Sequences

Campaigns

Live

Sync inbox

Sign in to LinkedIn first, then Sync.

Export CSV

Your CRM

Sign in to LinkedIn

press Sync inbox and a browser opens on the login page

Not reading

Today: 0 of 20

7 conversations on this computer

Search name or message...

J/K move · E archive · H snooze · ; snippets · N note

PR

Priya Raman

operations lead, logistics

No, we haven't built anything like that yet.

12m

TW

Tom Whitfield

runs a two-person design studio

Yeah it's in the process right now.

29m

GA

Grace Adeyemi

accountant, own practice

What would that actually involve?

48m

DO

Daniel Okonkwo

freelance developer

Not right now, maybe later in the year.

1h

HL

Hannah Lindqvist

copywriter

Interesting. Send it over.

2h

MB

Marcus Bell

founder, small agency

Thanks for reaching out.

5h

IM

Ines Moreau

consultant

Opener B, the one you sent.

6h

Priya Raman

operations lead, logistics

Profile

Hide details

Hi Priya - saw you're running things on your own. Have you built yourself a second brain yet, or is it still all in your head?

No, we haven't built anything like that yet.

Hi {name}, saw you built {their build} - how is that going?

Send

Ctrl+Enter sends a copy is written to your outbox first

this still has {name}, {their build} in it, which is a gap nothing filled in. Write the words in yourself, or pick somebody the record is complete for.

NOTE

Private note (local only)...

SNOOZE

3 hours

Tomorrow

Next week

LABELS

Create a label in the rail.

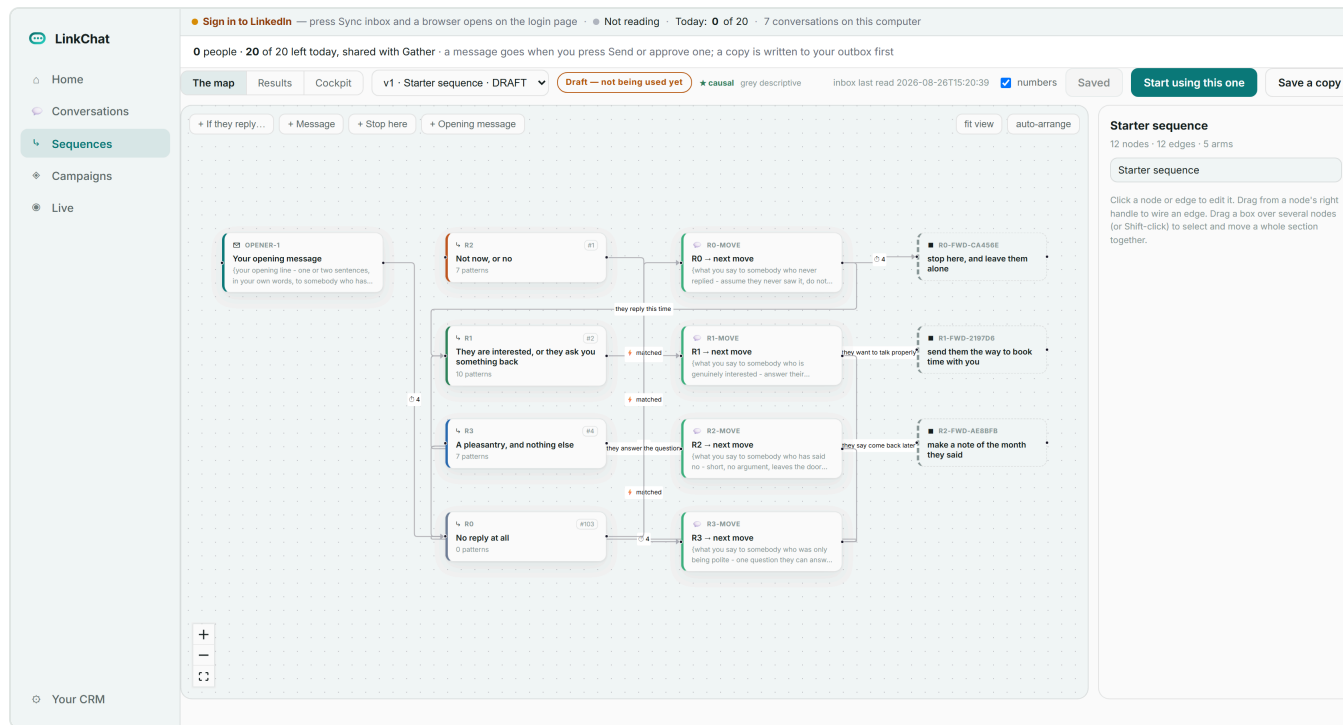
Pin

Archive

A refusal, in the place you were typing. The message still had `{name}` and `{their build}` in it, so it was refused and the gaps were named. **A check that refuses is the check working.** Nothing was sent, and nothing was lost — the words are still in the box.

Sequences

What you say when somebody replies, and to which kind of reply. Press **Start from the shape** and you get this rather than a blank canvas.



The starter shape: one opening message and the four ways back from it — no reply at all, a pleasantry and nothing else, not now, and they are interested or they ask you something. Each box on the right is what you say next.

EVERY MESSAGE IN IT IS A GAP, AND THAT IS DELIBERATE

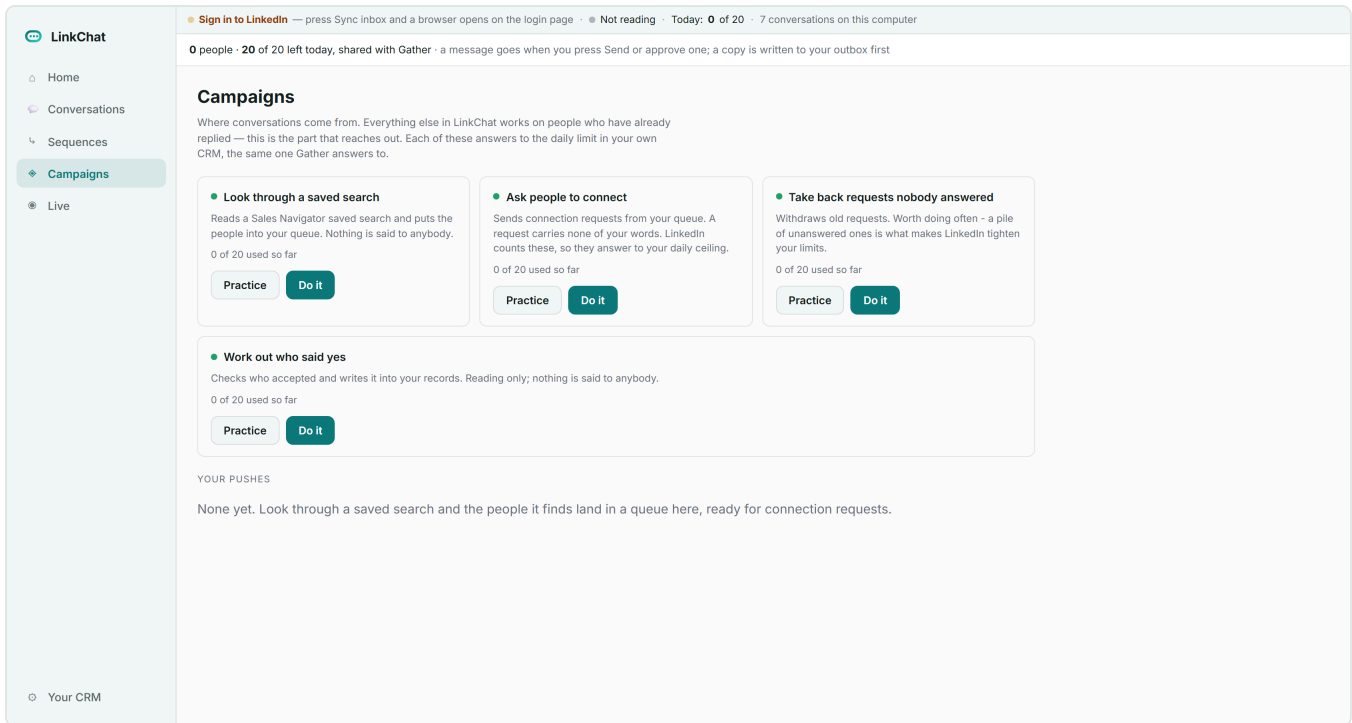
Nothing in the starter shape contains words you could send. Every message body is something for you to write, and check three above physically refuses to send a message with a gap left in it. Handed real copy, you could send five messages you had never read. This way you cannot.

The two groups that feel like failures are the two largest. **No reply at all** and **a pleasantry and nothing else** are where most people end up, and they are where a written answer is worth the most, because at the moment you have none.

A branch matches on patterns — short pieces of what somebody actually wrote. Three characters is the shortest a pattern may be. When nothing matches, the conversation is off the map and LinkChat proposes nothing at all, which is the right answer: a sequence that always has something to say is a sequence that is guessing.

Campaigns

Where conversations come from. Everything else works on people who have already replied — this is the part that reaches out.



Four jobs, each with two buttons. **Practice** does everything except the outward action and tells you what it would have done. **Do it** does it. Nothing on this screen presses Do it for you.

Each one reads the same daily limit in your CRM that Gather reads — the line under each job, **0 of 20 used so far**, is that number. There is no second set of counts anywhere in LinkChat.

WHY ONE LIMIT AND NOT TWO

LinkedIn counts the account, not the program. Two programs each keeping their own tally is how both stay inside a limit while the account goes over it. So LinkChat keeps none of its own, asks yours, and refuses when it cannot read it. A limit that cannot be consulted is not an absent limit.

One consequence worth knowing: the limit is shared across all four jobs and your messages. Message twenty people and reading a saved search will refuse too, until tomorrow.

Live

What LinkChat is doing now, and what your CRM has recorded. Read from your own event log — nothing on this screen sends or changes anything.

LinkChat

Home

Conversations

Sequences

Campaigns

Live

Your CRM

Sign in to LinkedIn — press Sync Inbox and a browser opens on the login page · Not reading · Today: 0 of 20 · 7 conversations on this computer

3 people · 20 of 20 left today, shared with Gather · a message goes when you press Send or approve one; a copy is written to your outbox first

Live

What LinkChat is doing now, and what your CRM has recorded. Read from your own event log — nothing on this screen sends or changes anything.

Nothing running. The browser opens by itself when you press Sync inbox.

WHAT YOUR CRM HAS RECORDED

9 min ago	message sent	Hannah Lindqvist
14 min ago	they replied	Priya Raman
32 min ago	message sent	Grace Adeyemi
36 min ago	message sent	Priya Raman
2 hours ago	connected	Marcus Bell
2 hours ago	they replied	Tom Whitfield

Newest first, refreshed every two seconds while a sync is running and every ten otherwise. These lines are written by your CRM, not by LinkChat, which is why they are still there if you stop using LinkChat entirely.

An entry naming no person means the record could not be matched to somebody in your CRM at the moment it was written. It is shown rather than hidden, because a screen that quietly drops what it cannot explain is a screen you cannot trust about anything else.

When something is wrong

Nothing opens when you double-click the icon

Open a terminal, move into the folder, and run the doctor:

```
cd %USERPROFILE%\Documents\LinkChat  
python doctor.py
```

The most common cause is Python being installed without **Add python.exe to PATH** ticked. The doctor says so in those words.

It says the browser is not started

Go to Conversations and press **Sync inbox**. That is what opens it. A window appears on the LinkedIn login page, and it can open behind the LinkChat window, so check your taskbar. Sign in once, come back, press Sync inbox again.

A message is refused

Read the sentence it gives you: it names which of the five checks refused and why. A check that refuses is the check working. Do not look for a way around it.

It says your conversations file is damaged

Close LinkChat, move the file it names somewhere else, and open LinkChat again. It builds a new one and reads your inbox back in. Your people, your outbox and your records are separate files and are untouched.

Getting the newest version

```
cd %USERPROFILE%\Documents\LinkChat  
git pull
```

Your CRM is a different folder, so nothing you have written is touched by that.

Changing it yourself

The whole program is there and you can change any part of it. A file called `CLAUDE.md` in the folder is read by Claude Code on its own, and is mostly a list of what must never be changed: none of the five checks may be weakened, widened or worked around, and the file that talks to your CRM is not to be edited. A fix that seems to need one of those loosened is the point to stop and ask.

LinkChat · github.com/ashleydeansmith/linkchat

The pictures in this document are of the program running, on invented people.